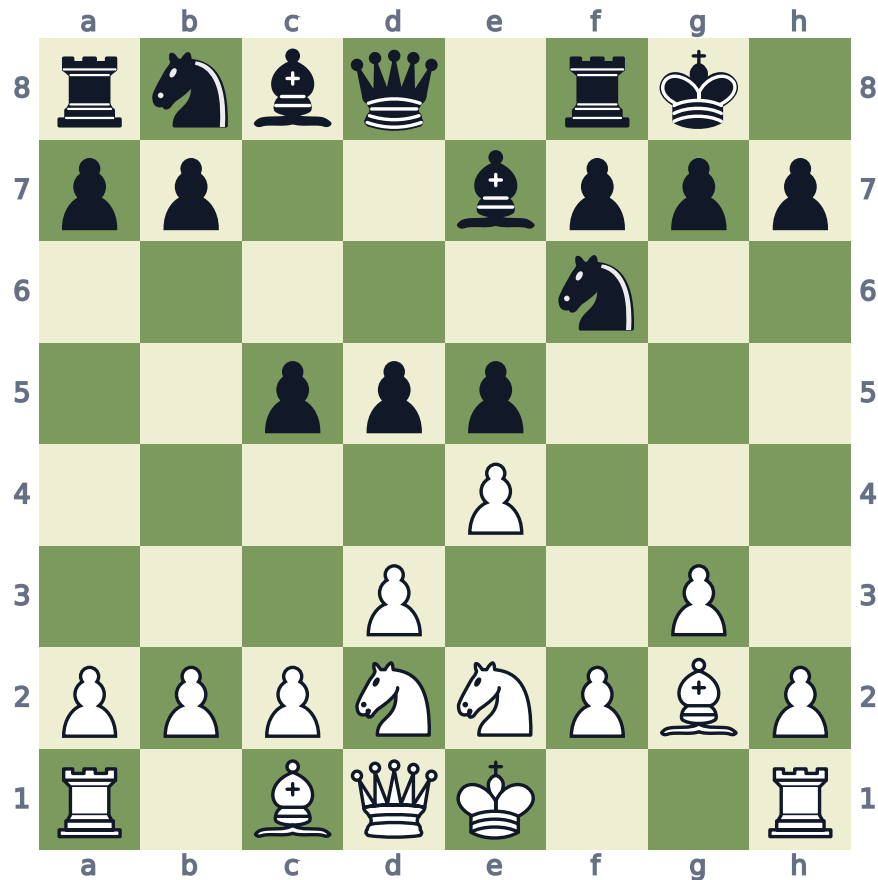


White Hippo vs d5-e5 Classical Centers

Full pawn centers, c5 and f5 expansion, early e4, and central contact



Meet Black's broad classical center with timely e4, c4, or d4 breaks instead of completing a passive shell.

8 learning units | solid-piece diagrams | recall tests | engine checks

ORIENTATION

How to study this volume

PURPOSE

Meet Black's broad classical center with timely e4, c4, or d4 breaks instead of completing a passive shell.

THE WHITE HIPPO TRAINING LOOP

- Identify Black's center, both kings, and Black's most forcing pawn break.
- At every diagram compare e4, d4, c4, and f4 before choosing another setup move.
- Hide the answer until you have spoken the move, purpose, and Black's best reply.
- Replay each branch from both sides in Fritz or another board program.
- Review misses after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.
-

WHAT COMPLETE MEANS HERE

This volume contains 8 units inside a connected 1.g3 repertoire. It teaches setup, exceptions, transformation, and resulting plans; the companion PGNs make later updating possible.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 1-3

PRINCIPLE 1

A full d5-e5 center controls space but presents two pawn-chain bases.

PRINCIPLE 2

e4 creates direct central contact and often opens the g2 bishop.

PRINCIPLE 3

c4 attacks d5 and can produce English or Queen's Pawn structures.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

STRATEGIC FOUNDATION

Principles 4-6

PRINCIPLE 4

d4 may simplify the center when Black's e-pawn is less secure.

PRINCIPLE 5

Black's f5 or c5 expansion shortens White's deadline.

PRINCIPLE 6

If Black advances e4, White must decide whether to exchange, undermine, or reroute immediately.

VERIFICATION QUESTION

What would have to be true for one of these principles to be wrong in the current position? Check forcing moves before applying a strategic rule.

REPERTOIRE MAP

Branches 1-8

- | | | |
|-----------|---|---|
| 01 | e4 against the full center | Play e4 before the broad center becomes a fixed wall. |
|
 | | |
| 02 | c4 against the full center | After c4-d4, name the second break before maneuvering. |
|
 | | |
| 03 | d4 against e5 | d4 is a transformation into an open or closed central game. |
|
 | | |
| 04 | Meet Black's c5 expansion | When Black plays c5, the d4 square becomes the center of the plan. |
|
 | | |
| 05 | Meet Black's f5 expansion | Against f5, calculate e4 before completing the queenside shell. |
|
 | | |
| 06 | Meet an early h5-h4 | A wing attack makes central contact more urgent. |
|
 | | |
| 07 | Classical development without c5 | A quiet center still has a deadline; choose the break on the next move. |
|
 | | |
| 08 | Black advances e4 | When e4 lands, resolve the center before returning to the shell. |

NAVIGATION RULE

Identify the pawn structure first, then confirm the move order. A familiar position reached by a different sequence should trigger the same plan.

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 01

e4 against the full center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c5 7. e4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Attack d5 and create central contact before Black advances.

MAIN DANGER

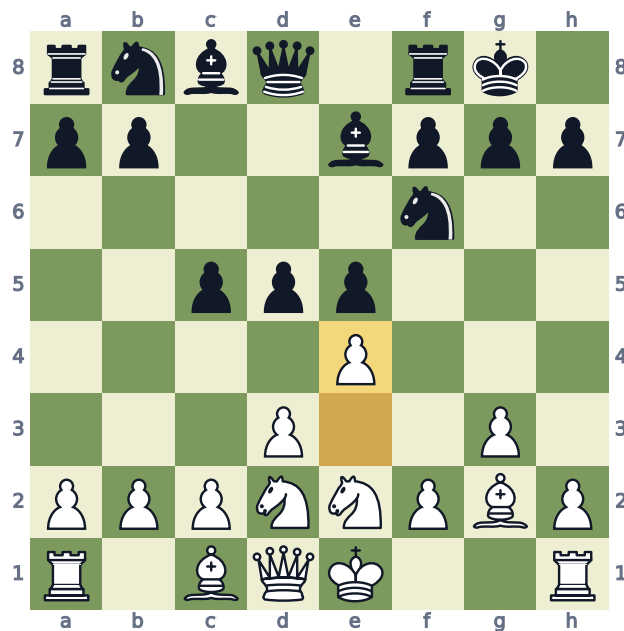
d4 can close the center and begin a queenside space grab.

BRANCH LOGIC 01

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Play e4 before the broad center becomes a fixed wall.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.84 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Nc6 O-O 2. Be6 b3 3. Qd7 Bb2

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 01

e4 against the full center



YOUR TASK

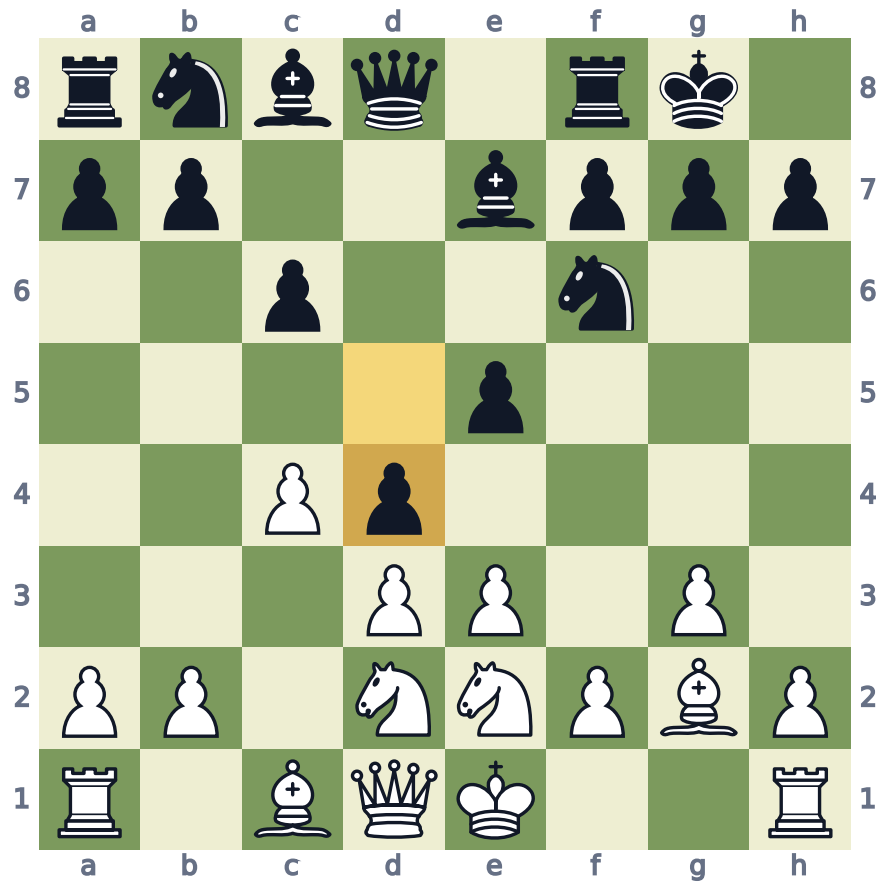
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 02

c4 against the full center



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Be7 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. c4 d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge d5 and use the c-file after exchanges.

MAIN DANGER

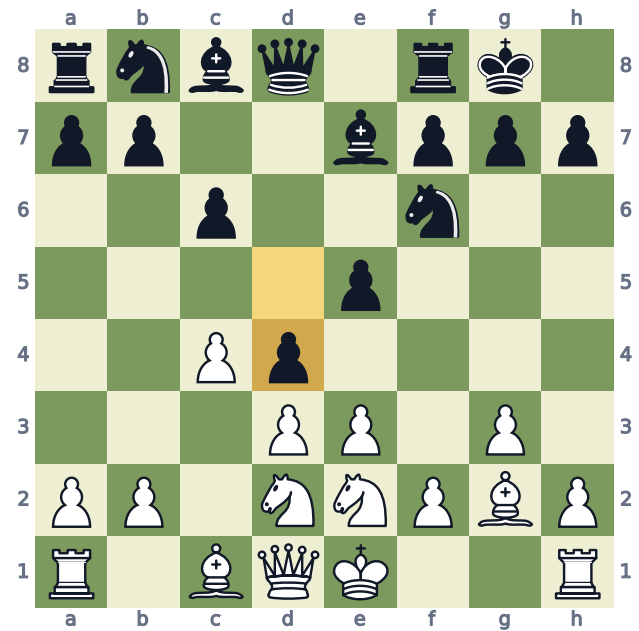
Black's d4 creates space and may restrict Nd2.

BRANCH LOGIC 02

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

After c4-d4, name the second break before maneuvering.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.09 for White (equal). Principal continuation: 1. exd4 exd4 2. O-O h6 3. Re1 Re8 4. Nf4 a5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 02

c4 against the full center



YOUR TASK

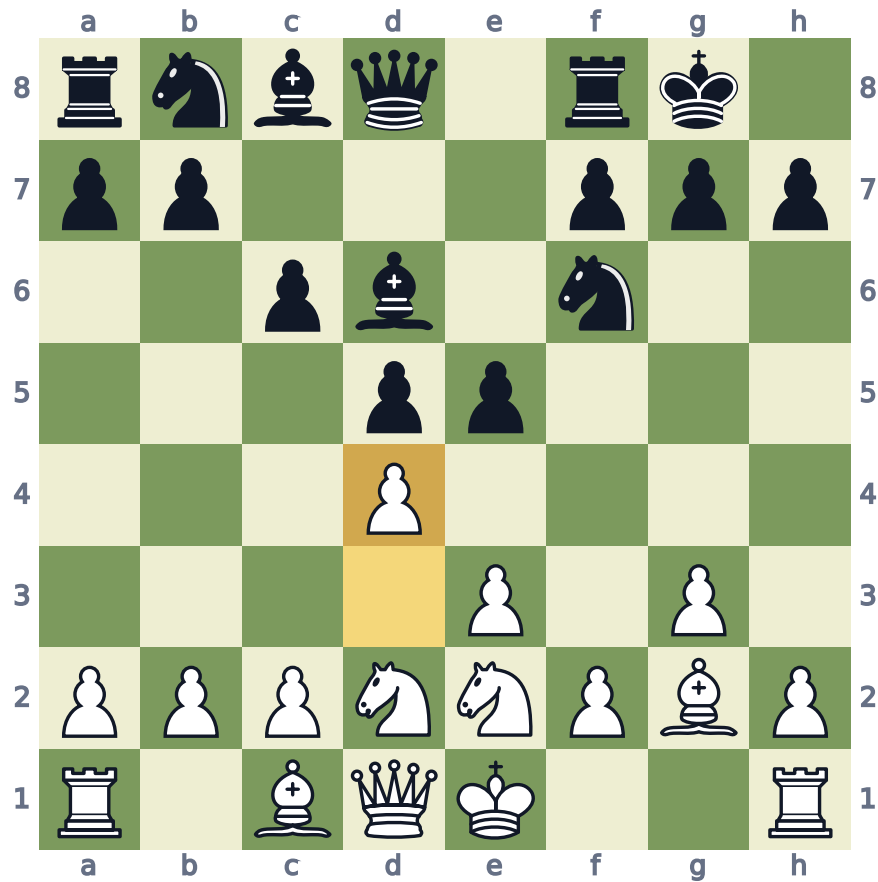
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 03

d4 against e5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 Bd6 5. e3 O-O 6. Ne2 c6 7. d4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Challenge e5 directly and invite a clarified center.

MAIN DANGER

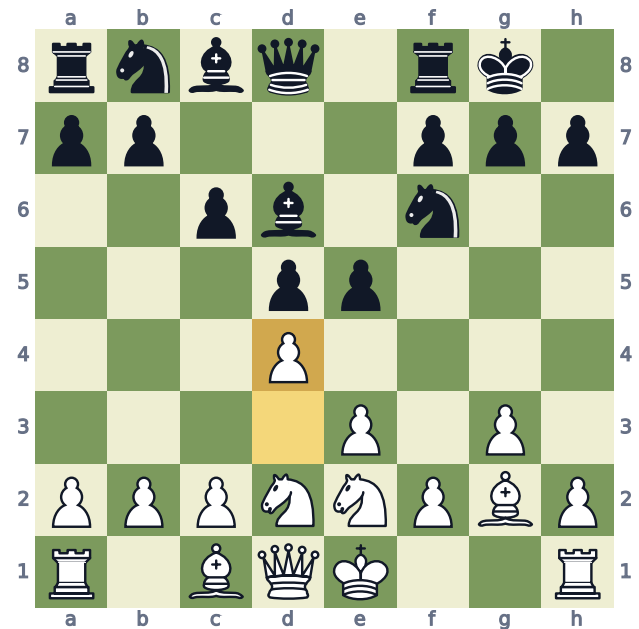
e4 can close the center and limit the g2 bishop.

BRANCH LOGIC 03

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

d4 is a transformation into an open or closed central game.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -1.07 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. e4 c4 2. b5 cxb5 3. cxb5 O-O 4. b4 f3 5. exf3 Nxf3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 03

d4 against e5

**YOUR TASK**

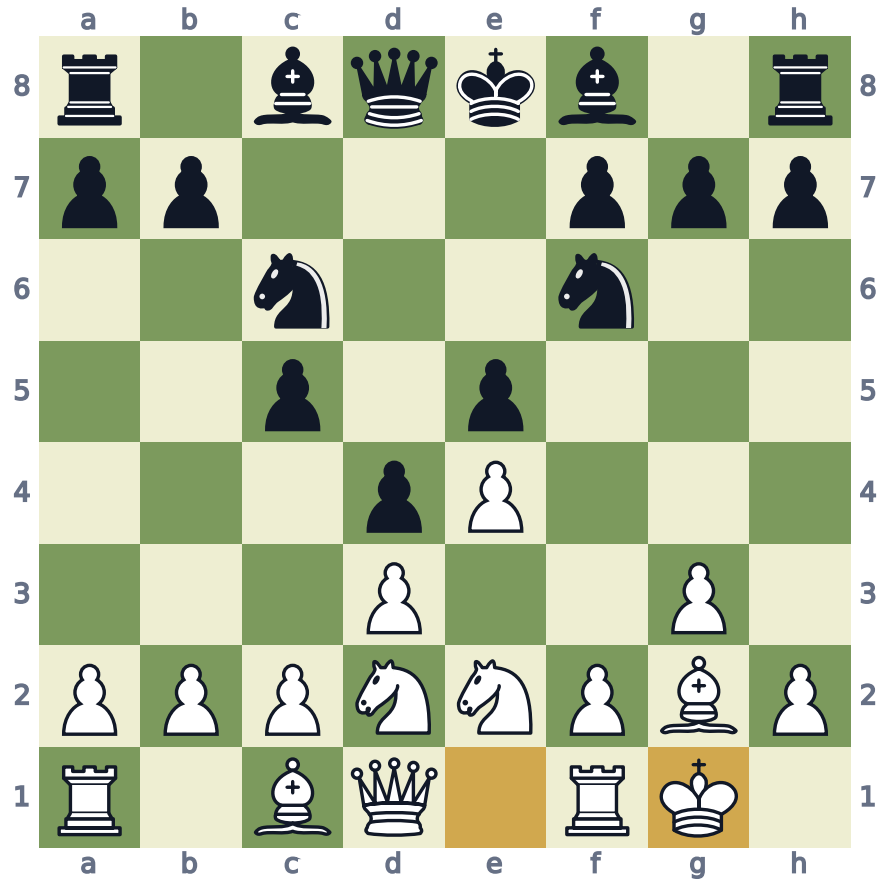
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 04

Meet Black's c5 expansion



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nf6 4. Nd2 c5 5. e4 d4 6. Ne2 Nc6 7. O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

Use e4 to restrain the center, then prepare f4 or c3 against d4.

MAIN DANGER

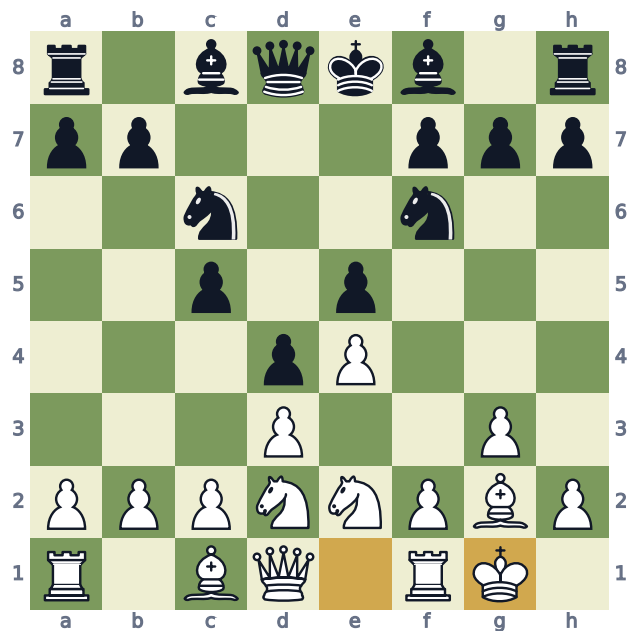
f5 can start a kingside attack while White is cramped.

BRANCH LOGIC 04

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When Black plays c5, the d4 square becomes the center of the plan.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

Position estimate: -0.54 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. h5 f4 2. h4 gxh4 3. Ng4 Nf3 4. Be7 Qe1

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 04

Meet Black's c5 expansion



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 05

Meet Black's f5 expansion



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 f5 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e4 fxe4 6. dxe4

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

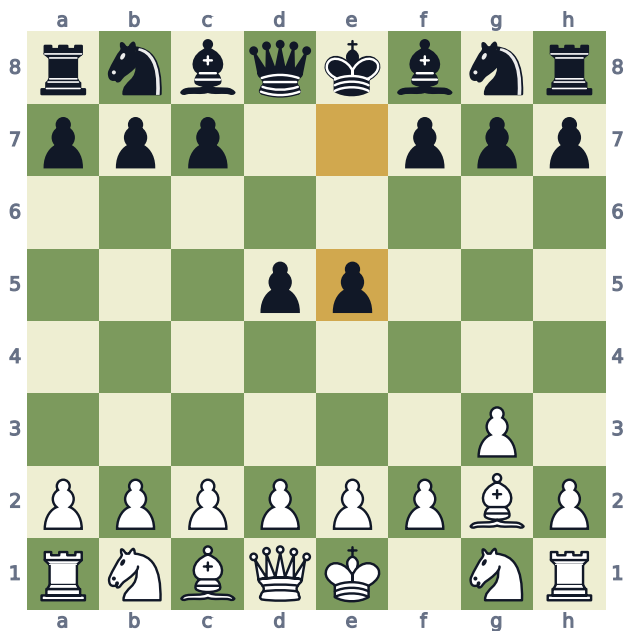
Open the center while Black's king and e-pawn are vulnerable.

MAIN DANGER

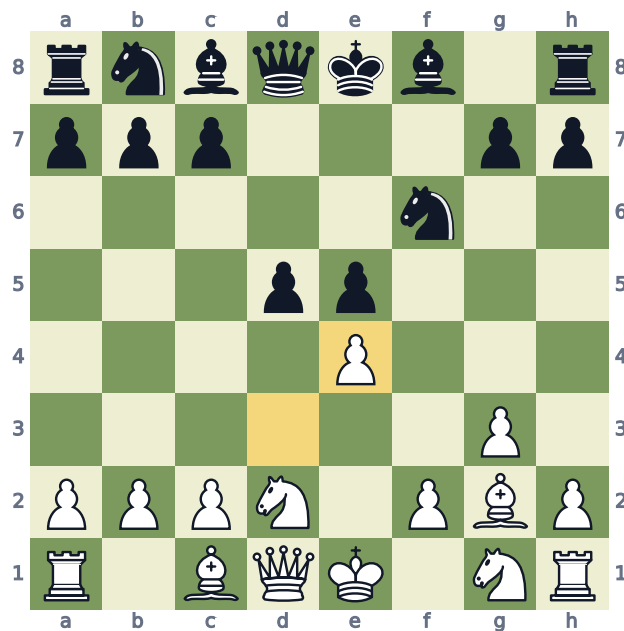
d4 can close the center with a kingside space edge.

BRANCH LOGIC 05

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

Against f5, calculate e4 before completing the queenside shell.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

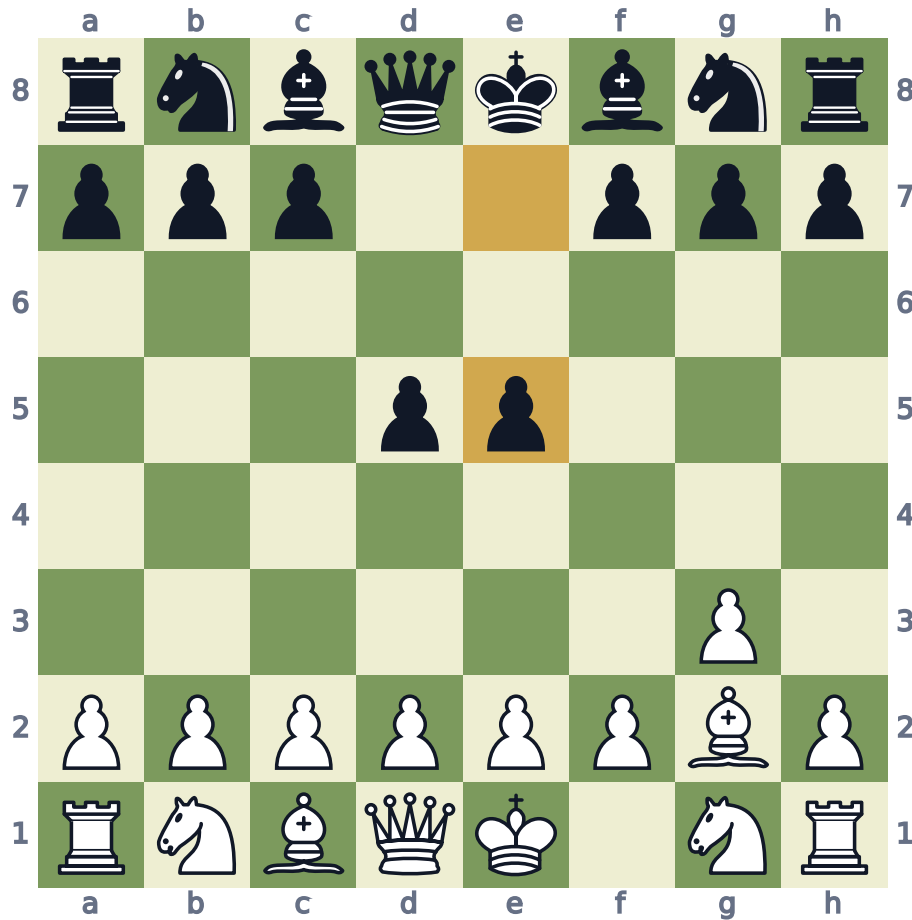
Position estimate: -0.49 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. Bc5 Qe2 2. O-O Ngf3 3. Qe8 exd5 4. e4 Ng5 5. Bg4 Qc4

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 05

Meet Black's f5 expansion



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 06

Meet an early h5-h4



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 h5 4. Nd2 h4 5. e4 d4 6. Ne2

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

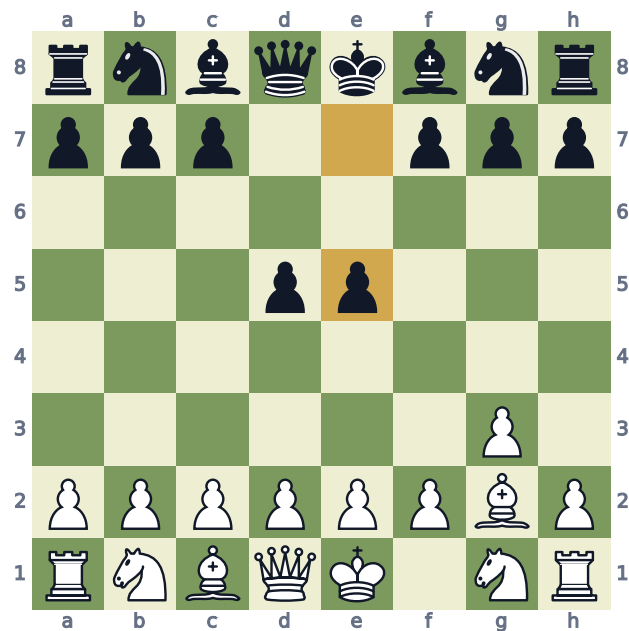
Counter in the center and avoid weakening the king with automatic pawn moves.

MAIN DANGER

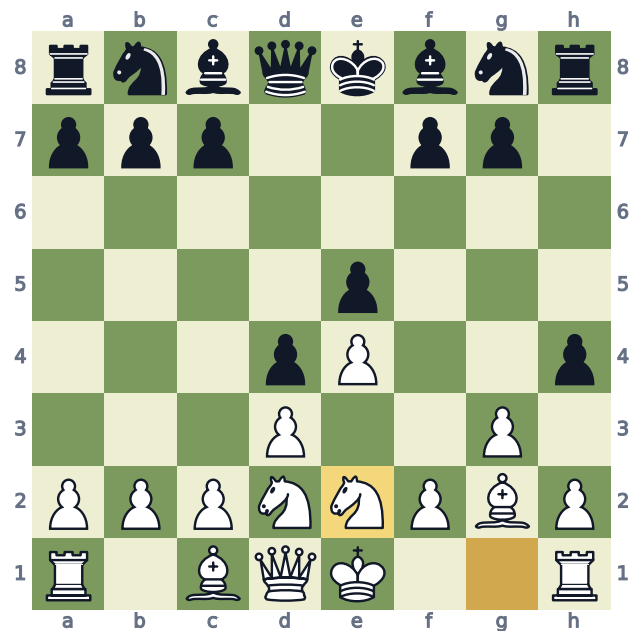
hxg3 can open a rook file or damage the structure.

BRANCH LOGIC 06

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A wing attack makes central contact more urgent.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

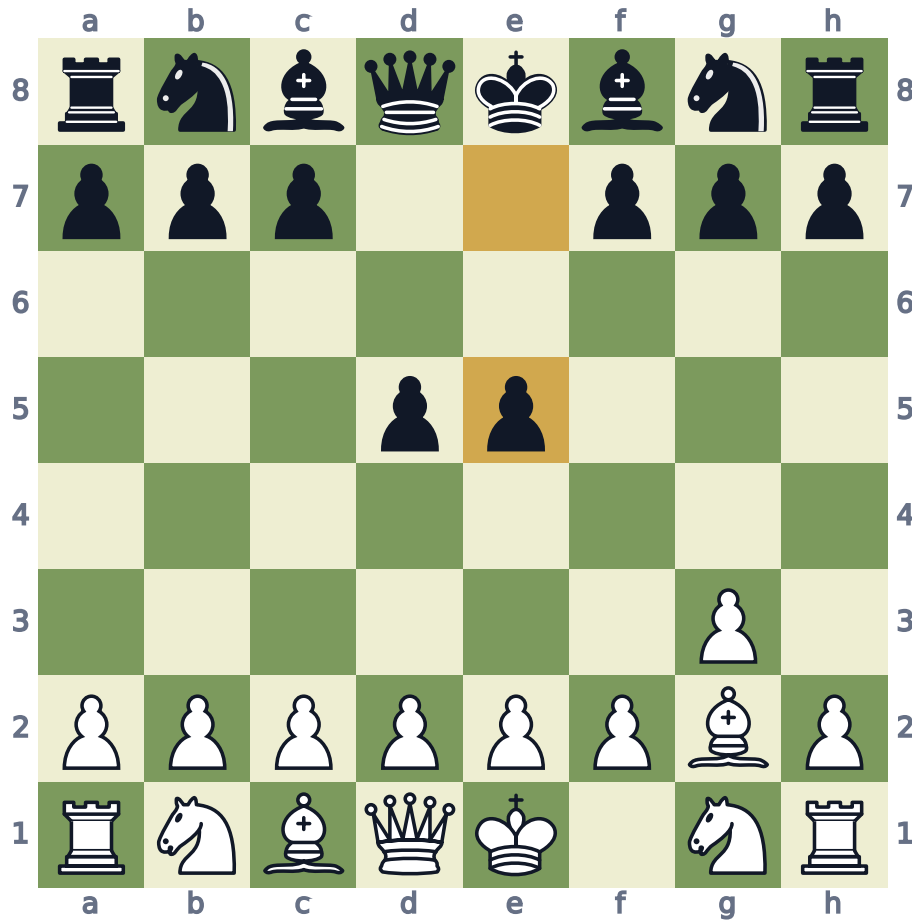
Position estimate: -1.16 for White (Black is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. h3 Bf3 2. Be6 O-O 3. Nc6 Nb3 4. Qd7 c3 5. dxc3 Nxc3

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 06

Meet an early h5-h4



YOUR TASK

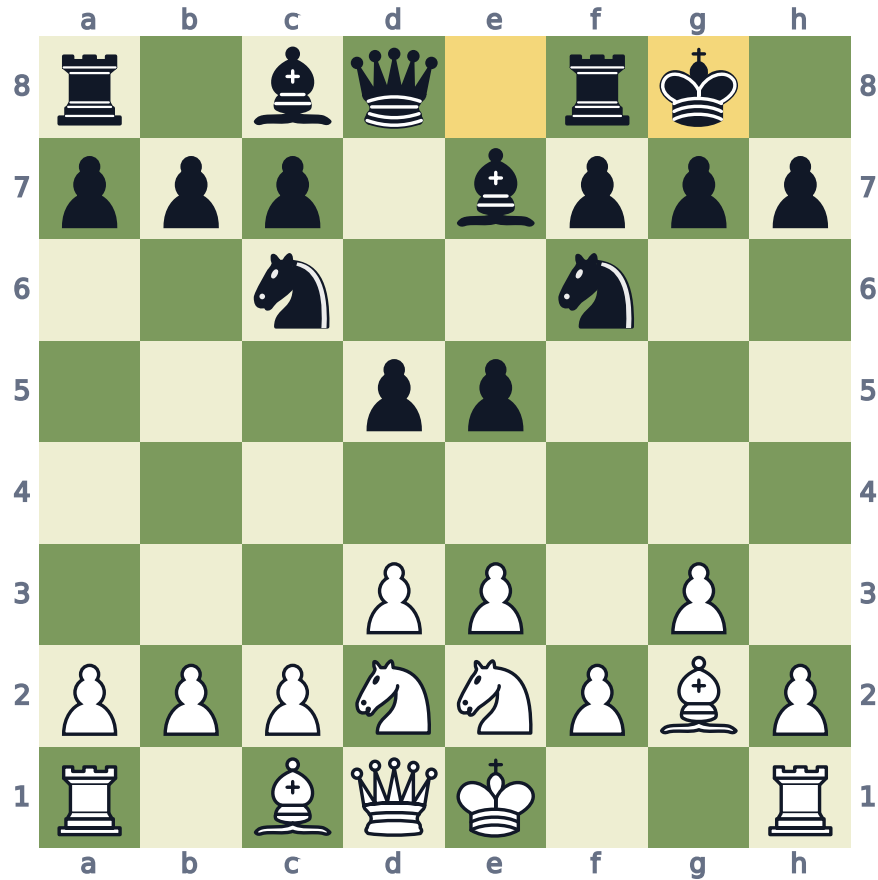
White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 07

Classical development without c5



COURSE LINE

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 Nc6 4. Nd2 Nf6 5. e3 Be7 6. Ne2 O-O

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

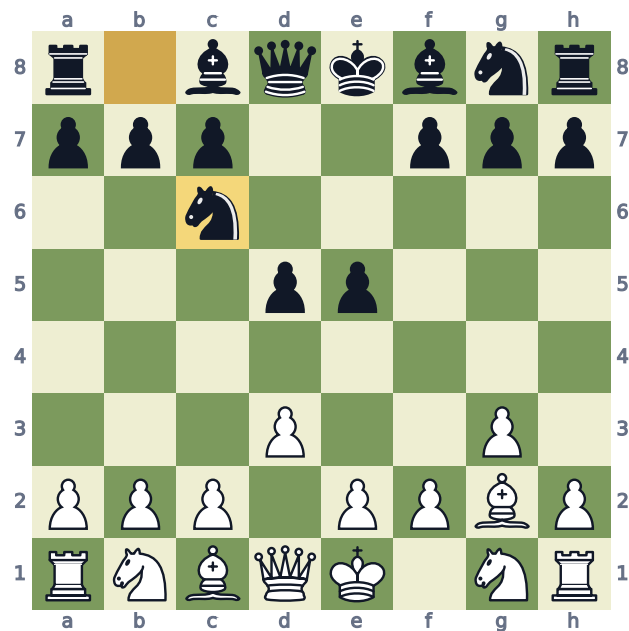
Complete development and preserve all three central breaks.

MAIN DANGER

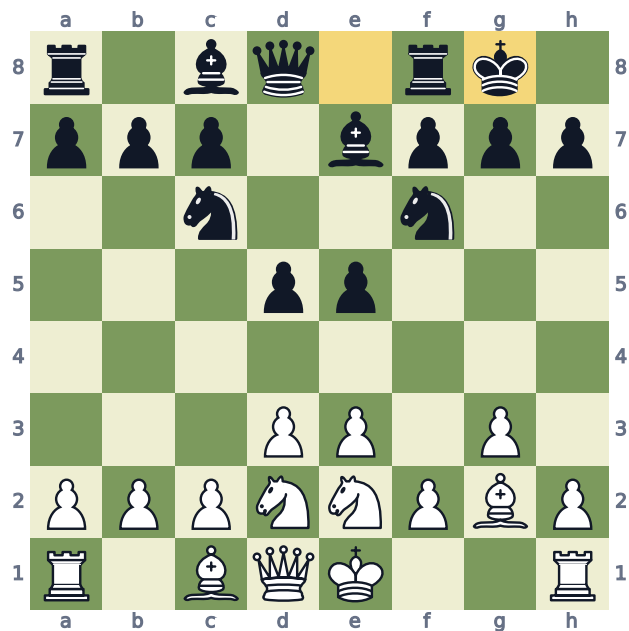
Black may use h5 or d4 before White acts.

BRANCH LOGIC 07

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 6 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

A quiet center still has a deadline; choose the break on the next move.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

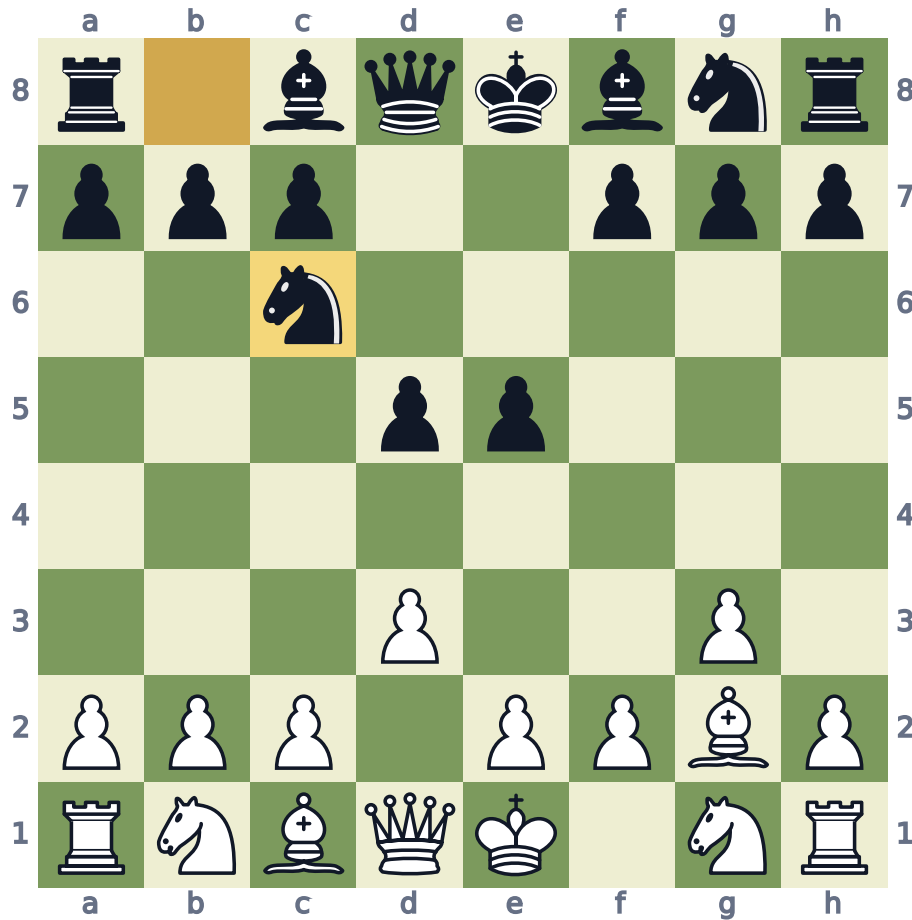
Position estimate: -0.43 for White (Black is slightly better). Principal continuation: 1. a3 Be6 2. b4 a5 3. b5 Na7 4. a4 c6 5. Bb2 cxb5

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 07

Classical development without c5



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

REPERTOIRE BRANCH 08

Black advances e4

**COURSE LINE**

1. g3 d5 2. Bg2 e5 3. d3 e4 4. dxe4 dxe4 5. Nc3 Nf6

COURSE-SIDE PLAN

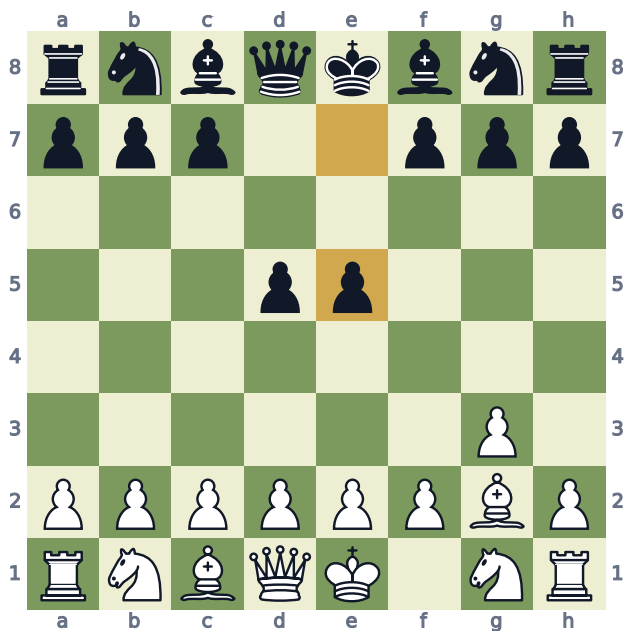
Exchange the advanced pawn and develop toward the newly opened center.

MAIN DANGER

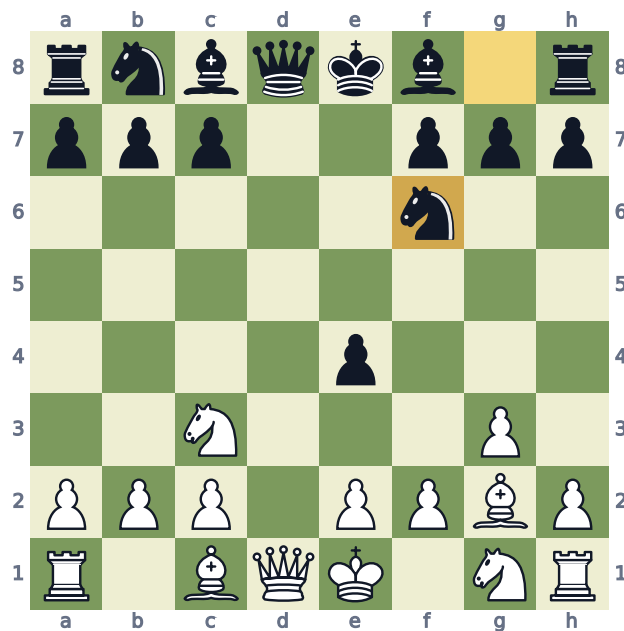
Black may exploit queen checks or the loose e4 pawn.

BRANCH LOGIC 08

Why the moves belong together



AFTER 4 PLIES



COURSE DESTINATION

MEMORY HOOK

When e4 lands, resolve the center before returning to the shell.

ENGINE CONTINUATION

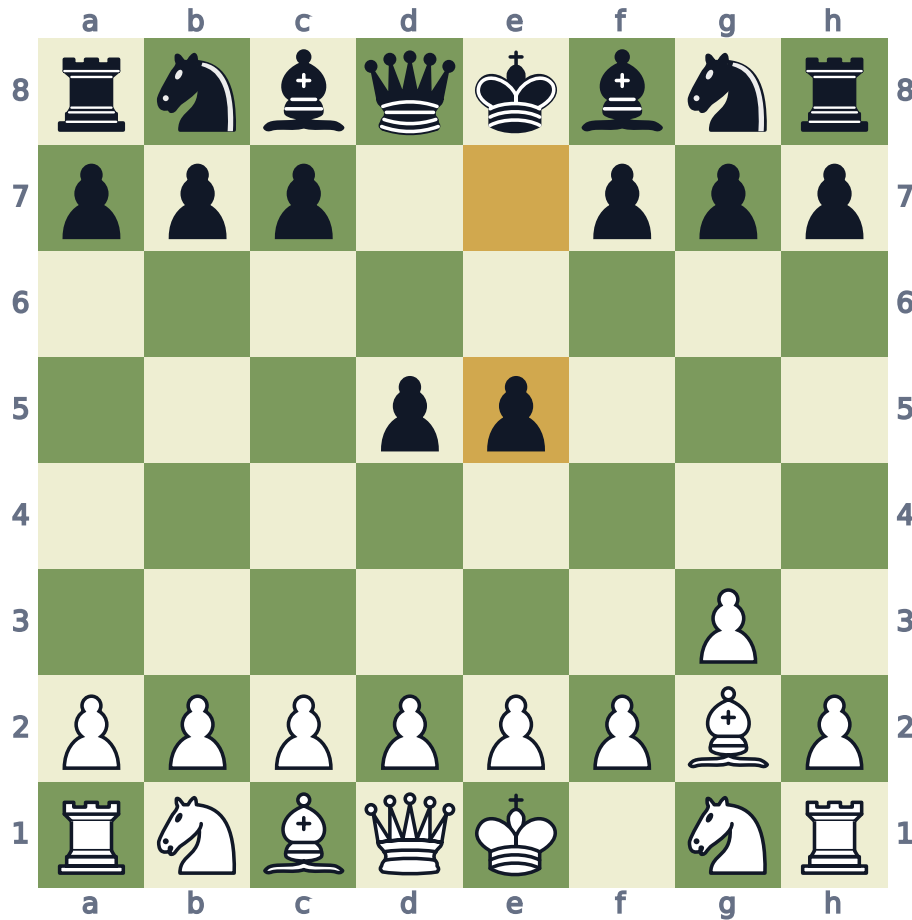
Position estimate: +1.92 for White (White is clearly better). Principal continuation: 1. Qxd8+ Kxd8 2. Bf4 Bd6

BOUNDARY CONDITION

Use the course line as a reliable destination, but recalculate when Black changes the center, creates a forcing threat, or gains a tactical tempo.

RECALL TEST 08

Black advances e4



YOUR TASK

White to move. Name the opening setup, choose the repertoire move, and explain its purpose. Then give the opponent's most challenging reply and one plan for the resulting structure. Do not move the pieces until the full answer is spoken or written.

SCORING

2 move | 2 purpose | 2 Black reply | 2 structure plan | 1 tactical check | 1 notation = 10

ANSWER SECTION

Recall solutions begin here

PROTECT THE TRAINING EFFECT

Do not read a solution until you have committed to a move and purpose. A matching move without the correct reason earns partial credit. If the course move is not the engine's first choice, compare plans rather than treating the engine as a memorization oracle.

ERROR LABELS

M = move-order memory | T = tactical oversight | P = plan misunderstanding | V = visualization | C = calculation | R = rushed recognition

REPAIR RULE

Every miss must produce a question you can use in future games. Example: 'When Black supports d5 with c6, which pawn break or recovery method does my repertoire use?'

SOLUTIONS

Answers 1-3

01. E4 AGAINST THE FULL CENTER

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Attack d5 and create central contact before Black advances. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: d4 can close the center and begin a queenside space grab.

02. C4 AGAINST THE FULL CENTER

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge d5 and use the c-file after exchanges. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black's d4 creates space and may restrict Nd2.

03. D4 AGAINST E5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Challenge e5 directly and invite a clarified center. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: e4 can close the center and limit the g2 bishop.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 4-6

04. MEET BLACK'S C5 EXPANSION

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Use e4 to restrain the center, then prepare f4 or c3 against d4. Engine comparison: 1. c4 c6 2. Nf3 Bd6 3. O-O h6 4. Nc3 (-0.22 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: f5 can start a kingside attack while White is cramped.

05. MEET BLACK'S F5 EXPANSION

Course move: d3. Purpose: Open the center while Black's king and e-pawn are vulnerable. Engine comparison: 1. d4 exd4 2. Nf3 Bb4+ 3. Nbd2 Be7 4. Nxd4 c5 5. Nb5 Nf6 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: d4 can close the center with a kingside space edge.

06. MEET AN EARLY H5-H4

Course move: d3. Purpose: Counter in the center and avoid weakening the king with automatic pawn moves. Engine comparison: 1. d4 exd4 2. Nf3 Bb4+ 3. Nbd2 Be7 4. Nxd4 c5 5. Nb5 Nf6 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: hxg3 can open a rook file or damage the structure.

SOLUTIONS

Answers 7-8

07. CLASSICAL DEVELOPMENT WITHOUT C5

Course move: Nd2. Purpose: Complete development and preserve all three central breaks. Engine comparison: 1. Nf3 Be6 2. O-O Qd7 3. a3 a5 4. Nc3 Nge7 5. Nb5 Ng6 (-0.25 for White (Black is slightly better)). Warning: Black may use h5 or d4 before White acts.

08. BLACK ADVANCES E4

Course move: d3. Purpose: Exchange the advanced pawn and develop toward the newly opened center. Engine comparison: 1. d4 exd4 2. Nf3 Bb4+ 3. Nbd2 Be7 4. Nxd4 c5 5. Nb5 Nf6 (-0.18 for White (equal)). Warning: Black may exploit queen checks or the loose e4 pawn.

VOLUME REVIEW

Make the repertoire usable

REVIEW TASK 1

Reconstruct every branch from the first move without looking.

REVIEW TASK 2

For each branch, explain one Black plan and one White plan.

REVIEW TASK 3

Shuffle the recall positions so the chapter title cannot reveal the answer.

REVIEW TASK 4

Play each starting position against Fritz from both sides.

REVIEW TASK 5

Add mistakes from your own games to the PGN as new training positions.

REVIEW TASK 6

Retest the weakest three branches after 1, 3, 7, 14, 30, and 60 days.

GRADUATION STANDARD

Score at least 80 percent twice, one week apart, and explain every move in plain language. Then maintain the volume through your own games instead of rereading it continuously.